Zachari Pond

Ph.D. Candidate, Agricultural and Resource Economics, University of California, Berkeley
zac_pond@berkeley.edu | zacpond.github.io

Education

University of California, Berkeley
Ph.D. in Agricultural & Resource Economics — Expected 2027
Committee: James Sallee (chair), Dmitry Taubinsky, Kelsey Jack, Meredith Fowlie
M.S. in Agricultural & Resource Economics — 2023

Brigham Young University
B.A. in Economics and Mathematics, *summa cum laude* — 2021

Fields

Environmental Economics, Behavioral Economics, Public Economics

References

James Sallee
Dept. of Agricultural & Resource Economics
University of California, Berkeley
sallee@berkeley.edu

Dmitry Taubinsky
Department of Economics
University of California, Berkeley
dmitry.taubinsky@berkeley.edu

Kelsey Jack
Haas School of Business
University of California, Berkeley
kelseyjack@berkeley.edu

Job Market Paper

"The Welfare Effects of Providing Information about Externalities."

Abstract: This paper combines theory and experiments to study the welfare effects of providing information about personal carbon emissions. I consider three information interventions: impact-based information, which privately reveals the dollar damages from one's annual emissions; social comparison information, which privately reveals one's emissions rank among participants; and public recognition, which discloses one's emissions profile to another participant. In the experiment, consumer welfare effects are measured with a strategy-method elicitation that captures participants' (possibly negative) willingness to pay for each intervention. Each intervention is then randomized across participants, with abatement effects measured through voluntary contributions to emissions offsets. I find that on average participants have positive willingness to pay for both impact-based information and social comparison information; willingness to pay for public recognition is positive if emissions are low and negative if emissions are high. Only public recognition increases abatement. The private information interventions increase consumer welfare but do not reduce external damages, whereas the public recognition intervention reduces consumer welfare while also reducing external damages. Under reasonable abatement cost curvatures, public recognition reduces total welfare despite having the intended impact on behavior, highlighting the importance of consumer welfare in evaluating non-standard policy interventions.

Publications

Frandsen, B. and Z. A. Pond. 2025. "Simultaneous Confidence Intervals for Partially Identified Parameters." *Journal of Business & Economic Statistics*, 43(1): 232–240.

Working Papers

"Welfare Effects of Climate Change for Outdoor Recreation," with J. Gellman and M. Wibbenmeyer.

Pre-PhD Publications (Environmental Health)

Pond, Z. A., P. K. Saha, C. J. Coleman, A. A. Presto, A. L. Robinson, and C. A. Pope III. 2022. "Mortality Risk and Long-term Exposure to Ultrafine Particles and Primary Fine Particle Components in a National US Cohort." *Environment International*, 167: 107439.

Coleman, C. J., R. A. Yeager, Z. A. Pond, D. W. Riggs, A. Bhatnagar, and C. A. Pope III. 2022. "Mortality Risk Associated with Greenness, Air Pollution, and Physical Activity in a Representative US Cohort." *Science of the Total Environment*, 824: 153848.

Pond, Z. A., C. S. Hernandez, P. J. Adams, S. N. Pandis, G. R. Garcia, A. L. Robinson, J. D. Marshall, R. Burnett, K. Skyllakou, P. Garcia Rivera, E. Karnezi, C. J. Coleman, and C. A. Pope III. 2022. "Cardiopulmonary Mortality and Fine Particulate Air Pollution by Species and Source in a National US Cohort." *Environmental Science & Technology*, 56(11): 7214–7223.

Garcia III, G. R., N. C. Coleman, Z. A. Pond, and C. A. Pope III. 2021. "Shape of BMI-Mortality Risk Associations: Reverse Causality and Heterogeneity in a Representative Cohort of US Adults." *Obesity*, 29(4): 755–766.

Pope III, C. A., N. Coleman, Z. A. Pond, and R. T. Burnett. 2020. "Fine Particulate Air Pollution and Human Mortality: 25+ Years of Cohort Studies." *Environmental Research*, 183: 108924.

Research & Professional Experience

Research Intern, Resources for the Future	2023
Research Assistant to C. Arden Pope III, Brigham Young University	2019–2021
Research Assistant to Brigham Frandsen, Brigham Young University	2020–2021

Grants & Awards

Giannini Foundation of Agricultural Economics Mini-Grant ($35,000)	2026
Giannini Foundation of Agricultural Economics Mini-Grant ($35,000)	2024
Xlab Graduate Student Research Funding ($7,000)	2024
Giannini Foundation of Agricultural Economics Mini-Grant ($35,000)	2023
Outstanding Graduate Student Instructor Award, UC Berkeley	2022

Teaching Experience

Economic Analysis for Business Decisions, UC Berkeley Haas (MBA)	2026
Intermediate Microeconomics with Applications to Sustainability, UC Berkeley	2025, 2026
Natural Resource Economics, UC Berkeley	2025
Environmental Economics, UC Berkeley	2022, 2024
Psychology and Economics, UC Berkeley	2023
Economics of Water Resources, UC Berkeley	2023
International Environmental Economics, UC Berkeley	2021, 2022
Introduction to Econometrics, Brigham Young University	2020
Intermediate Microeconomic Theory, Brigham Young University	2019

Conferences & Presentations

USDA W5133 Environmental Economics Annual Meeting	2026
AERE Summer Conference	2024
AERE Sessions at the Western Economic Association International Annual Conference	2024

Service

Admissions Committee, UC Berkeley ARE	2025
Graduate Assembly Delegate, UC Berkeley	2023

Referee

Journal of Public Economics

Last updated: October 15, 2026